Earth and Planets · Tier Pack · Independent

Learning goal: I can describe the Sun, Earth, and Moon as spheres and explain what orbits what in our solar system.

Independent Route (Book First)

Write the eight planets in order from the Sun, draw a labelled diagram showing Earth orbiting the Sun and the Moon orbiting Earth, and give one piece of evidence that Earth is a sphere.

Help: Order: M__, V__, E__, M__, J__, S__, U__, N__. The __ orbits the Sun, while the __ orbits the Earth.

Optional Make It · Independent

Make a Solar System Order & Orbit Strip

Fold an 8-box strip in planet order from the Sun, mark the rocky/giant split, and draw the Sun-Earth-Moon orbit arrows in your book.

Word Help

sphere: a round 3D ball shape, like the Sun, Earth, and Moon

orbit: the curved path one object in space takes around another because of gravity

solar system: the Sun and the eight planets (plus moons and rocks) that orbit it

star: a giant ball of hot glowing gas that makes its own light, like our Sun

Exit Check

What 3D word describes the shape of the Sun, Earth, and Moon?

List the first four planets in order from the Sun.